

YODEP STUDY

Yoruba-English Acted Depression Speech Corpus

Researcher Session Script & Briefing Document

Carnegie Mellon University Africa | Kigali, Rwanda | 2026

Supervised by Prof. Prasenjit Mitra

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Study Overview

This document is the complete session script for the YODEP speech recording study. It covers everything that takes place from the moment the participant arrives to the moment they leave. Follow the sections in order. Text in italics inside square brackets is a stage direction for you; do not read it aloud to the participant.

Study at a Glance

Purpose: To create a bilingual acted speech corpus for depression detection research.

Duration: Approximately 20 minutes per participant.

Location: Photo Studio, CMU Africa, Kigali.

Languages: English and Yoruba (both conditions recorded per participant).

What participants do: Read five sentences twice — once naturally, once in an acted depressed emotional state.

Data release: Anonymised audio released publicly on GitHub under CC BY 4.0.

Session Structure

Step 1: Welcome and Consent (3 minutes)

Step 2: Background Questions (2 minutes)

Step 3: Normal Condition Recording — English (4 minutes)

Step 4: Acted Depressed Condition Recording — English (5 minutes)

Step 5: Normal Condition Recording — Yoruba (4 minutes)

Step 6: Acted Depressed Condition Recording — Yoruba (5 minutes)

Step 7: Debrief and Close (2 minutes)

Step 1 — Welcome and Consent (3 minutes)

[Greet the participant warmly as they arrive. Offer them a seat. Ensure the room is quiet and the recording device is ready but not yet recording.]

Researcher says:

Welcome, and thank you for coming. My name is Peace, and I am a Master's student here at CMU Africa. I really appreciate you taking the time to support this research.

This study is part of my thesis, which is supervised by Professor Prasenjit Mitra. We are creating a bilingual speech dataset — in English and Yoruba — for research on depression detection. There is nothing medically invasive about this study at all. What I will ask you to do is simply read a few sentences out loud in two different ways.

Before we begin, I want to go through the consent form with you so you are fully clear on what will happen, how your data will be used, and what your rights are. Please feel free to ask any questions at any point.

[Hand the participant the printed consent form. Read through it with them or give them time to read it themselves.]

[Once the consent form is signed, begin the recording. Switch on the recording device now.]

Step 2 — Background Questions (2 minutes)

[These questions are for metadata only. Speak conversationally — do not read them from the page robotically.]

Researcher says:

Before we start the recording, I just have a few quick background questions. There are no right or wrong answers.

Questions to ask verbally:

- Can you confirm your age range for me — are you between 18 and 24, 25 and 30, or older?
- Would you describe Yoruba as your first language or mother tongue, or is it a language you speak fluently but learned later?
- Do you have any voice or speech conditions I should know about — for example, a stutter, chronic laryngitis, or anything like that? This does not exclude you at all; it is just for our records.
- On a scale of 1 to 5, how would you rate your own ability to act or perform expressively? 1 being not at all theatrical, 5 being very expressive.

[Note responses on the metadata sheet. Do not record these verbally — this is background only.]

Step 3 — Normal Condition: English (4 minutes)

[Check recording device is active. Announce the condition clearly for the audio log.]

Researcher says (for audio log):

Recording: Participant [ID], English, Normal condition, sentences S1 to S5.

Instructions to participant:

I will now show you five sentences on this card. Please read each one out loud, naturally, just as you would say it in a normal conversation. Take your time. If you stumble on a sentence, simply pause, and we will do a second take. There is no hurry.

Sentence Card — English (Normal Condition)

[Hand the participant the printed sentence card. Point to each sentence as they read.]

Sentence	English	Yoruba
S1	I submitted my assignment late again.	— English only this round —
S2	The study room was full when I checked.	— English only this round —
S3	It's been very cold lately.	— English only this round —
S4	My roommate mentioned going to the market this weekend.	— English only this round —
S5	I have a deadline coming up, and I'm just getting started.	— English only this round —

[Allow up to two takes per sentence. Note which take is best on your metadata sheet (T1 or T2). Say 'Thank you' after each sentence before moving to the next.]

Step 4 — Acted Depressed Condition: English (5 minutes)

[Do not hand the sentence card yet. Deliver the prompting scenario first. Read it slowly and clearly.]

Prompting Scenario — Read Aloud to Participant:

*“Please imagine that you have been feeling low and tired for some time.
Your energy is low, it is harder to focus, and you feel less engaged than usual.*

Now, keeping that in mind, please read the following sentences naturally as if you were in that state.”

Just sit with that for a moment.

[Pause for 30 seconds. Do not rush this. Let the participant settle. Watch for readiness before continuing.]

Researcher says:

Whenever you are ready — from that place — please read the same sentences again.

Researcher announces for audio log:

Recording: Participant [ID], English, Depressed condition, sentences S1 to S5.

[Hand the sentence card. Allow two takes per sentence as needed. Note the best take on the metadata sheet.]

[After the last sentence, say: 'Thank you — that was really well done.']

[Give the participant a moment to settle before moving to the Yoruba conditions.]

Step 5 — Normal Condition: Yoruba (4 minutes)

Researcher announces for audio log:

Recording: Participant [ID], Yoruba, Normal condition, sentences S1 to S5.

Instructions to participant:

Now we will do the same thing in Yoruba. Again, please read each sentence naturally, as you would say it in everyday conversation.

Sentence Card — Yoruba (Normal Condition)

Sentence	English	Yoruba
S1	— Yoruba only this round —	Ó tún ti pé mi láti fi isé àmúrelé mi sílè
S2	— Yoruba only this round —	Iyàrá ikàwé ti kún nígbàtí mo yẹ ibè wò
S3	— Yoruba only this round —	Òtútù ti òmú jù lénu ọjó mọta yìí
S4	— Yoruba only this round —	Abánipin-yàrá mi sọ wípé òun nlo sí ọjà lo pin òsè yí
S5	— Yoruba only this round —	Àkókò-ìpàrì mi ti súnmọ, sùgbọ̀n mo ẹ̀sẹ̀ nberẹ̀ ní

[Allow up to two takes per sentence. Note the best take on the metadata sheet.]

Step 6 — Acted Depressed Condition: Yoruba (5 minutes)

[Deliver the prompting scenario again. The participant has had a break since the English depressed condition. Re-read the scenario fully.]

Prompting Scenario — Read Aloud Again:

Let us go back to that same place once more. You have just received a call from a close friend. Both your parents were in a serious accident, and they did not survive. You have been sitting alone for three hours. You have not eaten or spoken to anyone. You are completely drained.

Whenever you are ready.

[Pause 30 seconds. Wait for readiness.]

Researcher announces for audio log:

Recording: Participant [ID], Yoruba, Depressed condition, sentences S1 to S5.

[Hand the Yoruba sentence card. Allow two takes per sentence. Note best take on metadata sheet.]

[After the last sentence, stop the recording.]

Step 7 — Debrief and Close (2 minutes)

[Do not skip this step. Every participant must be debriefed after the depressed condition recording. Speak warmly and unhurriedly.]

Researcher says:

That is everything — thank you so much for your time and for doing this so thoughtfully. I really appreciate it.

Just to close the loop — how are you feeling right now? Is there anything you need?

I want to remind you that the scenario I asked you to imagine was entirely fictional. Everything is fine. You did a great job.

Your recordings will be anonymised before they are released. Your name will appear in the acknowledgements [according to your preference]. Anyone contributing significant time — including helping with Yoruba verification — may be considered as a co-author on any paper that comes from this work.

If you have any questions at any time, you can reach me on WhatsApp. Thank you again — this really means a lot to the research.

[If the participant shows any signs of distress, do not end the session abruptly. Stay with them, offer water, and check in before they leave.]

[After the participant leaves: complete the metadata sheet for this session before the next participant arrives.]

Full Sentence Reference

The following table contains all five sentences in both English and Yoruba for quick reference during the session.

Sentence	English	Yoruba
S1	I submitted my assignment late again.	<i>Ó tún ti pé mi láti fi isé àmúrelé mi sílè</i>
S2	The study room was full when I checked.	<i>Iyàrá ikàwé ti kún nígbàti mo yẹ ibè wò</i>
S3	It's been very cold lately.	<i>Òtútù ti òmú jù lénu ọjó mẹta yí</i>
S4	My roommate mentioned going to the market this weekend.	<i>Abánipin-yàrá mi sọ wípé òun nlo sí ọjà lo pin ọsè yí</i>
S5	I have a deadline coming up, and I'm just getting started.	<i>Àkókò-ìpàrì mi ti súnmọ, sùgbọ̀n mo ẹ̀sẹ̀ ẹ̀sẹ̀ nberẹ̀ ní</i>

[Print one copy of this table as a sentence card to hand to participants. Print separately from this script.]

Session Metadata Sheet

[Complete one copy of this page per participant immediately after their session.]

Speaker ID: P____

Session Date: _____

Session Time (start): _____

Age Range: 18–24 / 25–30 / 31–35 / 36+

Gender: Male / Female / Prefer not to say

Yoruba proficiency: Native / Fluent / Conversational / None

Self-rated acting score (1–5): ____

Voice condition noted: Yes / No — Notes: _____

Acknowledgement preference: Full name / First + initial / Initials / Anonymous

Best takes per sentence — EN:

- S1: T1 / T2 S2: T1 / T2 S3: T1 / T2 S4: T1 / T2 S5: T1 / T2

Best takes per sentence — YO:

- S1: T1 / T2 S2: T1 / T2 S3: T1 / T2 S4: T1 / T2 S5: T1 / T2

Researcher observations (acting quality, notable moments, any concerns):

Researcher signature: _____ **Date:** _____